

Email: lalthoff@stanford.edu

Web: www.lukasalthoff.com

EMPLOYMENT

Stanford University

Assistant Professor, Department of Economics

Since 2025

Postdoctoral Fellow, Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research (SIEPR)

2023 – 2024

EDUCATION

Princeton University

Ph.D. in Economics

2018 – 2023

London School of Economics

M.Sc. in Econometrics and Mathematical Economics

2017 – 2018

University of Munich

B.Sc. in Economics

2014 – 2017

Technical University of Munich

B.Sc. in Computer Science and Finance

2013 – 2017

AFFILIATIONS

Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research, Faculty Fellow

Since 2025

Stanford Center on Poverty and Inequality, Faculty Affiliate

Since 2025

CESifo, Affiliate Member

Since 2024

US Census Bureau, Special Sworn Status Researcher

Since 2023

Institute of Labor Economics (IZA), Research Affiliate

Since 2023

VISITING POSITIONS

NYU Stern School of Business

2024 – 2025

Center for Economic Studies (CES), University of Munich

2024

Opportunity & Inclusive Growth Institute (OIGI), Minneapolis Fed

2023

PUBLICATIONS

“Jim Crow and Black Economic Progress After Slavery”

2024

with Hugo Reichardt

[Quarterly Journal of Economics](#)

“The Geography of Remote Work”

2022

with Fabian Eckert, Sharat Ganapati, Conor Walsh

[Regional Science and Urban Economics](#)

WORKING PAPERS

- "Task-Specific Technical Change and Comparative Advantage"** 2026
with Hugo Reichardt
- "America's Rise in Human Capital Mobility"** 2025
with Harriet Brookes Gray, Hugo Reichardt
[Review of Economic Studies, Revise & Resubmit](#)
- "Two Steps Forward, One Step Back: Racial Income Gaps among Women since 1950"** 2023

WORK IN PROGRESS

- "Race-Blind Policy and Racial Inequality: Long-Run Evidence from World War II"**
with Christiane Szerman

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Seminar presentations

- 2026 (*incl. scheduled*): Federal Reserve Board, UC Santa Barbara, University of Houston, University of Pittsburgh, University of Southern California
- 2025: German Ministry of Finance, Harvard, Northwestern, Rockwool Foundation, UNSW Sydney
- 2024: Brookings, Chicago Fed, German Ministry of Finance, NYU, Stanford, UC Davis, UCLA Anderson, UC Merced
- 2023: Berkeley, Harvard, LSE, Minneapolis Fed, Stanford, Stanford GSB, Stellenbosch (LEAP), Tilburg, UChicago Booth, UChicago Harris, University of British Columbia, University of Munich, Yale SOM
- 2022: Applied Young Economist Webinar, City University of New York, Florida State, Institute for the World Economy, Princeton
- 2021: Princeton, Princeton History, YSI-EHES Economic History Graduate Webinar

Conference presentations

- 2026 (*incl. scheduled*): NBER Race and Stratification, CEPR Applied Micro & Economic History Workshop
- 2025: NBER Summer Institute, Australian Political Economy Workshop, German Economists Abroad Conference, Stanford Provostial Fellows Symposium
- 2024: NBER Summer Institute, Opportunity Insights Conference, "Institutions, Organizations, and Growth" (UChicago BFI), "Barriers to Economic Opportunity and Inclusion" (UChicago & Cleveland Fed), SED Annual Meeting
- 2023: NBER Summer Institute, Foundations of Long-Run Prosperity Conference (Hoover Institution), Chicago Economic History Workshop, UC Davis Economic History Workshop, Economic History Rookiefest (Northwestern), Southern Economic Association Conference
- 2022: NBER Economics of Mobility, NBER Summer Institute, CESifo Venice Summer Institute, Conference on Urban and Regional Economics (Philadelphia Fed), European & North American Meetings of the Urban Economics Association, Lindau Nobel Laureate Meeting, Economic History Association, Inequality Conference (UKonstanz), Rising Scholars Conference (UChicago Booth), Workshop on "Causal Inference with Spatial Data" (RWI), Development and Political Economics Graduate Student Conference (Berkeley & Stanford), Yale Economic History Graduate Student Conference, Economic and Business History Society, CIREQ PhD Students' Conference, Warwick Economics PhD Conference, Workshop on "Racial and Ethnic

Disparities in the Labor Market” (Berkeley & Princeton), Workshop on “Racial Disparities in the 1944 G.I. Bill” (Brandeis)

Referee service

American Economic Journal: Applied Economics

American Economic Journal: Economic Policy

American Economic Review

American Economic Review: Insights

Economica

European Research Council

Explorations in Economic History

Journal of Economic History

Journal of Economic Literature

Journal of Labor Economics

Journal of Law and Economics

Journal of Political Economy

Journal of Regional Science

Journal of the European Economic Association

Journal of Urban Economics

National Science Foundation

Regional Science and Urban Economics

Regional Studies

Review of Economic Studies

Review of Economics and Statistics

Quarterly Journal of Economics

Award Committees

John Locke Institute Global Essay Prize

US Fiscal Challenge

AWARDS, GRANTS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

Awards

W.E. Upjohn Institute Dissertation Award 2023

Erik Olin Wright Prize, Havens Wright Center for Social Justice 2023

Princeton University Graduate Student Teaching Award 2022

Urban Economics Association Best Student Paper Award 2022

IPUMS USA Best Student Research Award 2022

Grants

Anthropic Economic Futures Grant (\$50,000) 2025

Stanford Impact Labs (\$50,000) 2025

Russell Sage Foundation (\$66,000) 2024

Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research (\$10,000) 2023

Princeton Program for Research on Inequality (\$10,000) 2021

Fellowships

Stanford Impact Labs Design Fellowship	2025 – 2026
Prize Fellowship in the Social Sciences, Princeton University	2022 – 2023
Doctoral Fellowship, Princeton University	2018 – 2023
German National Scholarship Foundation Fellowship	2017 – 2018
German Academic Exchange Service Fellowship	2017 – 2018
Dr Jost Henkel Foundation Fellowship	2017 – 2018
Deloitte Foundation Fellowship	2015 – 2017
Hans Rudolf Foundation Fellowship	2015 – 2016
Hanns Seidel Foundation Fellowship	2013 – 2017
Claussen Simon Foundation Fellowship	2012 – 2013

TEACHING

Graduate

Topics in US and International Economic History (Stanford ECON 226) Since 2025

This graduate course emphasizes theoretical and empirical methods for studying long-run economic change, centering around key challenges facing society today: technological change, barriers to opportunity, environmental change, and political polarization. Drawing on historical evidence and economic analysis, we investigate how societies have addressed these challenges and what lessons the past provides for the future. While the evidence spans various periods of history, the course does not cover periods chronologically but rather focuses on analysis of specific questions and mechanisms of change.

Undergraduate

Progress and Inequality (Stanford ECON 30) Starting 2026

This undergraduate course traces the history and future of economic progress and inequality, from forager societies to Artificial Intelligence. We examine long-run patterns across the world; modern trends in within- and between-country inequality; and the roles of race, technology, climate change, institutions, and policy. The class blends economic history with applied micro and data analysis. Students will read research, replicate key results, and analyze historical and contemporary datasets. We focus on mechanisms: how technology, markets, politics, climate, and system-wide shocks widen or narrow gaps; why some places converge while others diverge; and what has worked to expand opportunity.

Guest lectures

2026 (*incl. scheduled*): UCLA

2025: Stanford (Political Science), UC Irvine, Spelman College

2024: NYU Stern, Stanford

2023: Princeton